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New settings for your Search services

Search services have new settings to manage history and personalized recommendations that reflect your prior Web & App Activity preferences. Media (like your images and audio) from your interactions will now also be saved in your history. You can make changes to your settings any time.

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◆ AI Overview



During World War II, Nazi Germany established an extensive network of approximately 44,000 concentration camps, ghettos, transit camps, and extermination centers across Europe. Used for forced labor, systematic terror, and mass murder, the camps incarcerated Jews, political opponents, Roma, and other persecuted groups.  Kupferberg Holocaust Center

The extensive system of camps is categorized into specific types, with major historical sites as follows:

Major Concentration Camps

These camps were primarily used for forced labor, imprisonment, and torture, though mortality rates were extremely high:  Holocaust Encyclopedia +4

- **Dachau (Germany):** The first official Nazi concentration camp, opened in 1933.
- **Auschwitz (Occupied Poland):** Operated as both a massive concentration/forced-labor camp and the deadliest extermination center.
- **Buchenwald (Germany):** Established in 1937, it was one of the largest camps on German soil.
- **Mauthausen (Austria):** Established in 1938, it was notorious for its brutal, lethal working conditions in stone quarries.
- **Ravensbrück (Germany):** The largest concentration camp exclusively for women, established in 1939.  The National WWII Museum | New Orle... +3

Extermination / Death Camps

Six dedicated death camps were built in occupied Poland for the sole purpose of systematic mass murder, primarily through the use of gas.

systematic mass murder, primarily through the use of gas chambers:  The National WWII Museum | New Orle... +1

- **Auschwitz-Birkenau**
- **Treblinka**
- **Bełżec**
- **Sobibór**
- **Chełmno (Kulmhof)**
- **Majdanek (Lublin)**  The National WWII Museum | New Orle... +1

Transit Camps

Used as collection centers to hold people temporarily before deporting them to death camps in the East:  Holocaust Encyclopedia

- **Westerbork (Netherlands)**
- **Drancy (France)**
- **Mechelen (Belgium)**
- **Fossoli di Carpi (Italy)**  Holocaust Encyclopedia

Visiting and Remembrance Sites

Today, many of the major camp sites operate as educational museums and memorial sites. You can find visitor information, tour bookings, and historical data directly through official educational resources:  Rick Steves Europe

- **Historical overviews:** Learn about the geography of the Holocaust through the [USC Shoah Foundation](#) or the interactive maps provided by the [USHMM Concentration Camps Overview](#).
- **Memorial sites:** Explore survivor testimonies, museum hours, and plan visits to specific memorials (such as Dachau or Sachsenhausen) via the Memorial Museums Directory.

 9 sites

Concentration Camps, 1942–45 - Animated Map/Map

The Nazi camp system expanded rapidly after the beginning of World War II in September 1939, as forced labor became important in w...





 Holocaust Encyclopedia

The Nazi Concentration Camp System | New Orleans

In the Nazi camp system, no camps have commanded great historical attention than the so-called Vernichtungslager (extermination ca...



 The National WWII Museum | New ...

Sobering Sites of Nazi Europe by Rick Steves

While some visitors complain that the Dachau camp memorial is too "prettied-up," it gives a powerful look at how these camps worke...



 Rick Steves Europe

Major Nazi camps in Europe, January 1944 - Holocaust Encyclopedia

Throughout German-occupied Europe, the Germans arrested those who resisted their domination and those they judged to be racially i...



 Holocaust Encyclopedia

Concentration Camp System: In Depth - Holocaust Encyclopedia

Systematic Murder * Sachsenhausen (1936) * Buchenwald, near Weimar (1937) * Flossenbürg (1938) * Mauthausen (1938) * the women's c...

 Holocaust Encyclopedia

Concentration Camps, 1933–1939 - Holocaust Encyclopedia

Expansion of the Camp System ... Nazi Germany expanded by bloodless conquest into Austria and Czechoslovakia between 1938 and 1939...



 Holocaust Encyclopedia

Show all

AI can make mistakes, so double-check responses

Ask anything



JewishGen

<https://www.jewishgen.org> › general › listeeng ⋮

The List of the Camps

A star means that the inmates of the **camp** were women. This list is far from complete. It is estimated that the Nazis established 15,000 **camps** in the occupied ...



Holocaust Encyclopedia

<https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org> › content › gallery › co... ⋮

Concentration Camps, 1942–45 - Animated Map/Map

Major Nazi **camps** in Greater Germany, 1944 ... The Nazi **camp** system expanded rapidly after the beginning of World War II in September 1939, as forced labor became ...



The National WWII Museum | New Orleans

<https://www.nationalww2museum.org> › war › articles ⋮

The Nazi Concentration Camp System

Apr 22, 2025 — The Nazis created at least 44000 **camps**, including ghettos and other sites of incarceration, between 1933 and 1945. The **camps** served various ...



Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nazi_concentration_ca... ⋮

Nazi concentration camps

Nazi Germany built and operated a system of **concentration camps** (German: Konzentrationslager) between 1933 and 1945. There were more than a thousand, ...



Kupferberg Holocaust Center

<https://khc.qcc.cuny.edu/camps> ⋮

Inside the Nazi System of Incarceration and Genocide

Approximately 44,000 **concentration camps** and ghettos existed across Nazi-occupied **Europe** and North Africa during World War II. These incarceration sites, which ...



Rick Steves Europe

<https://www.ricksteves.com/read/articles/sobering-si...> ⋮

Sobering Sites of Nazi Europe

A trip to once-upon-a-time **Europe** can be a fairy tale. It can also help tell the story of **Europe's** 20th-century fascist nightmare.